Day 68 - Malcolm Bluff, Bob Light, Coveney's

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 89 · Malcolm Bluff

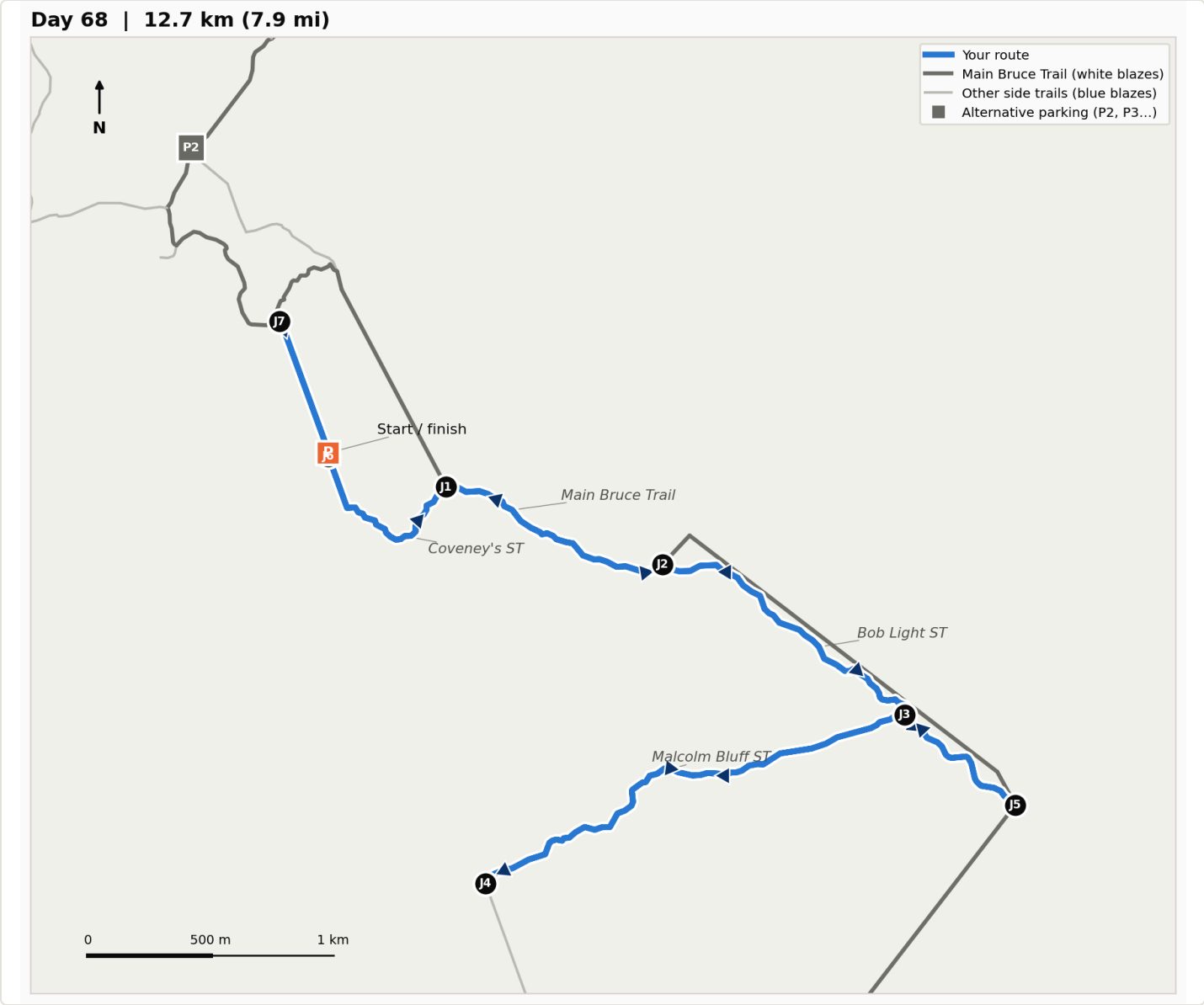
12.7 km / 7.9 mi	~4.6 h	5.4 km new	199 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Roadside Parking at the bend on the grassy shoulder of Coveney's Rd. Do not block private laneways. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day68_hike089.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Malcolm Bluff Side Trail (2.0 km); Bob Light Side Trail (2.0 km); Coveney's Side Trail (1.4 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Roadside parking on the grassy shoulder at the bend of Coveney's Rd. Don't block private laneways.
- **Road walking:** The Coveney's Side Trail begins and ends with a stretch along Coveney's Rd. The main trail also has a short road section each way. Walk on the shoulder and keep Zappy close.
- **Main Bruce Trail along Malcolm Bluff:** A 2015 trip report describes the escarpment edge as mature forest with little elevation change and firm, sometimes rocky footing. It mentions good views of Hay, Griffith and White Cloud Islands at the mouth of Colpoy's Bay. Stay back from the edge, where the report noted loose dolostone blocks.
- **Bob Light and Malcolm Bluff Side Trails:** Just before the Malcolm Bluff turn, the trail crosses an alvar, a stretch of open dolostone pavement with little soil. Ontario Nature Trails rates the area loop moderate, on natural and rocky ground.

- **Wildlife:** This area borders Malcolm Bluff Shores Nature Reserve, where black bears have been recorded.
- **Distance:** At 12.9 km, this is a long day. Ontario Nature Trails rates the Coveney's Side Trail area difficult, so pace yourselves and carry plenty of water.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Crooked Toe Parking: Courtesy of Chippewas of Nawash map	Free	12.3	1160 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside Parking at the bend on the grassy shoulder of Coveney's Rd. Head south on the blue-blazed Coveney's Side Trail. The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.8	0.5	J1: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.4	0.9	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
1.8	1.1	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Bob Light Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
3.1	1.9	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Malcolm Bluff Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Bob Light Side Trail goes off on your left.)
5.1	3.2	J4: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
7.1	4.4	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Bob Light Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Bob Light Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
7.8	4.8	J5: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
8.4	5.2	J3: Junction. Turn right to stay on the Bob Light Side Trail, heading north. (the Malcolm Bluff Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
9.7	6.0	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
10.1	6.3	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
10.7	6.7	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Coveney's Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
11.3	7.0	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.5	7.2	J6: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Coveney's Side Trail, heading north.
12.1	7.5	J7: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.
12.7	7.9	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails, Ontario Nature and the Vanderplas family's Bruce Trail journal.